

Anna Yan Liu

Institute of Communications Research, College of Media, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Illinois, US

College of Media, Institute of Communications Research

Ph.D. Candidate in Communication and Media (ABD)

Aug 2021 - present

Co-Advisors: Prof. Michelle R. Nelson & Prof. Ewa Maslowska

Dissertation in progress: Perceived Decontextualization and Consumer Responses to Quantitative Data in Advertising (Expected completion: April 2027)

Chinese University of Hong Kong, School of Journalism and Communication

Hong Kong, China

Master of Social Science | Majored in Advertising

Aug 2015 - Nov 2016

Renmin University of China, School of Journalism and Communication

Beijing, China

Bachelor of Arts | Majored in Journalism

Sep 2011 - Jul 2015

RESEARCH INTEREST

- **Keywords:** Strategic communication, Persuasion, Data, Emerging tech, Computational social science
- **Topics:**
 - *Data:* Data in message design, Persuasion, Data and context, Consumer data literacy
 - *Emerging technologies:* AI-generated summaries, focusing on generative engine optimization, online reviews, and social media; AI in information seeking; AI in small business advertising
- **Mixed methods:**
 - *Computational:* Computer vision, Machine learning, Sentiment analysis, Topic modeling, etc.
 - *Quantitative:* Experiment, Survey, Content analysis
 - *Qualitative:* Interview, Netnography, Focus group, Observation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Ipsos (China) Consulting Co., Ltd. (Marketing & consumer research agency)

Beijing, China

From *Research Executive* to *Senior Research Manager*

Aug 2016 - Jun 2021

- **Project Type:**
 - Brand and advertising: Advertising pre- and post-testing, Brand health tracking, Brand equity, etc.
 - Consumer study: Media habits, Purchase journey, Use and attitude, Segmentation, Lifestyle, etc.
 - Innovation & product test: Concept test, Product test, Package test, Price test, Line extension, etc.
- **Research Methods:**
 - Quantitative: Survey, Experiment, Content analysis
 - Qualitative: Focus group, In-depth interview, Observation, Home visit, Shop-along, Diary
 - Innovative methods and others: Eye-tracking, Social media analytics, Secondary research

Cheil Great China (4A advertising agency)

Beijing, China

Intern as Account Executive

Mar 2015 - Jun 2015

Tencent Charity Foundation (Fundraising platform for NGOs)

Beijing, China

Intern as New Media Managing Executive

Sep 2014 - Dec 2014

PUBLICATIONS

- Liu, A. Y.** & Zhang, M. M. (2026). Positivity Bias in AI-Generated Summaries of User-Generated Content: Exploring Its Sources and Impact on Public Sentiment. *Computational Communication Research*. <https://doi.org/10.5117/CCR2026.2.4.LIU>
- Liu, A. Y.** (2025). Ephemeral Visibility and Externally Visible Production: How Algorithmic Automation Accelerates Fans' Data Work. *New Media & Society*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448251393480>
- Liu, A. Y.**, Ji, A. R., Taneja, H. & Nelson, M. R. (2025). Stakeholder-Desired Audiences: Fans' Audience Data Imaginaries and How They Shape Industry Data Practices. *Convergence: The International Journal of Research into New Media Technologies*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/13548565251366412>
- Liu, A. Y.**, & Taneja, H. (2025). Visibility of K-pop in the US: Global Rankings, 'Audience Mis-aggregation', and Mainstream Attention to Niche Genre. *Convergence: The International Journal of Research into New Media Technologies*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/13548565251320755>
- Pan, S., & **Liu, A. Y.** (2018). Examining the Effect of WeChat Usage on the Social Capital among Chinese College Students. *Chinese Journal of Journalism & Communication*, 40(4), 126-143. <http://cjjc.ruc.edu.cn/CN/Y2018/V40/I4/126>

JOURNAL SUBMISSIONS

- Liu, A. Y.** (Revise & Resubmit). Post-Brand Visual Identity Congruence and Consumer Engagement: Computational Analysis on Color Similarity and Logo Presence in Brand Social Media Posts. *Journal of Current Issues & Research in Advertising*.
- Baptiste, P.*, Fukada, M.*, Lee, Y.*, **Liu, A. Y.***, & Nelson, M. R.* (Revise & Resubmit). How Audiences Negotiate the Changing Streaming Video Landscape: Accepting or Avoiding Advertising Depends on Your Advertising Socialization. *Advertising & Society Quarterly*.

* The authors contributed to the work equally.

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

- Liu, A. Y.**, & Zhang, M. M. (Journal submission). AI-Powered Information Seeking on Social Media: A Computational Analysis and Cross-Cultural Comparison on Global Users' @Grok Behaviors. [Status: Full manuscript submitted to AEJMC 2026 Annual Conference. Intended journal submission date: May 30, 2026.]
- Liu, A. Y.**, Maslowska, E., & Nelson, M. R. (Journal submission). How NGOs Use Data for Consumer Engagement: A Computer Vision Analysis of Informational, Visual, and Emotional Appeals in Visuals. [Status: Full manuscript submitted to AEJMC 2026 Annual Conference. Intended journal submission date: May 30, 2026.]

CONFERENCES

- Liu, A. Y.** (2025, Aug 7-10). *Ephemeral Visibility and Externally Visible Production: How Algorithmic Automation Accelerates Fans' Data Work*. Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC) Annual Conference, San Francisco, United States.
- Liu, A. Y.** (2025, Jun 12-16). *Context Matters: Exploring Consumers' Sense-Making of Online Ratings in the Social Context*. International Communication Association (ICA) Annual Conference, Denver, United States.

- Gong, Z., Chen, T., **Liu, A. Y.**, Xuan, J., & Su, L. Y. F. (2025, March 6-9). *Navigating Consumer Acceptance of Cultured Meat: An Exploratory Narrative Review of Communication Strategies*. American Academy of Advertising (AAA) Annual Conference, Pittsburgh, United States.
- Liu, A. Y.**, Ji, A. R., Taneja, H., & Nelson, M. R. (2024, March 27-30). *“Industry Imaginary” and Fans’ Reactivity to Measurements: How Fans Negotiate with the Media Industry Through Collective Data Manipulation*. Popular Culture Association Annual Conference, Chicago, United States.
- Liu, A. Y.**, Zhang, M. M., & Taneja, H. (2023, September 28-29). *Data Work Participation and Fan Identity: Network Analysis on Superfans’ Role in Mobilizing Fans’ Twitter Voting for Billboard Award [Working Paper]*. *Identity and Social Media Symposium: Bridging the Gaps between Computational Methods and Critical/ Cultural Perspectives at the University of Utah*, Salt Lake City, United States.
- Chen, C., **Liu, A. Y.**, Subedi, P., Liu, J.Y., Paltaratskaya, V., Nelson, M. R. (2023, March 23-26). *Constructing a “Metaverse” Typology Based on Affordances and Psychological Processes: A Systematic Literature Review*. American Academy of Advertising (AAA) Annual Conference, Denver, United States.
- Lee, D. *, **Liu, A. Y.***, Paltaratskaya, V.*, Park, S. *, Shao, J. *, Subedi, P. *, & Nelson, M. R. * (2022, October 20-23). *Moving Together into Web 3.0: Global Brand Use and Consumer Knowledge and Perceptions of Brand Non-Fungible Tokens and the Metaverse* [Poster presentation]. Annual Conference of the Association for Consumer Research, Denver, United States.
- Liu, A. Y.** (2019, April 5-7). *Chinese-style Public Service Advertising on CCTV: Change and Continuity*. In *Proceedings of the 5th World Conference on Media & Mass Communication* (pp. 25-34). <https://doi.org/10.17501/24246778.2019.5103>

* The authors contributed to the work equally.

TEACHING

Teaching Experience: Instructor of Record

ADV200 Data literacy	2026FA (Appointed)
ADV281 Advertising Research Method	2023FA

Teaching Experience: Teaching Assistant

ADV360 Innovations in Advertising (Discussion section leader)	2026SP
ADV201 Social Media and Personal Branding (Grader)	2026SP
ADV284 Consumer Insight (Discussion section leader)	2025FA
ADV250 Advertising and Brand Strategy Discussion section leader)	2024FA
ADV150 Introduction to Advertising (Discussion section leader)	2024SP
MACS100 Intro to Popular TV & Movies (Discussion section leader)	2022FA, 2023SP
ADV150 Introduction to Advertising (Grader)	2021FA, 2022SP

Teaching Certificate & Award

Graduate Teacher Certificate	2024
Center for Innovation in Teaching & Learning at UIUC	
List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent by their Students	2024SP, 2024FA
Center for Innovation in Teaching & Learning at UIUC	

Guest talk

ADV120 Consumer Data & Society (Research: Audience data and empowered audiences) 2025FA

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Research Assistantship

2026 James Webb Young Summer Graduate Scholar, Department of Advertising, UIUC 2026SU
(Research assistant to Dr. Michelle Nelson)

Research Grant

James Webb Young Grad Research Award, Department of Advertising, UIUC (\$500) 2025SP

Bart A. Cummings Advertising Gift Fund

Research fund for dissertation, Department of Advertising, UIUC (\$1,200) 2025SP

Petullo Fellowship

Fellowship offered by the Department of Advertising, UIUC (\$11,555) 2025SP

Travel Grant

James Webb Young Travel Fund, Department of Advertising, UIUC (\$500) 2025SP

MusicID 2024 Digital Research Fellowship

Project: Should we sing in their languages?: How language choices influence K-pop's charting across national borders on Spotify (\$1,000) Jun 2024

Travel Grant

Identity and Social Media Symposium: Bridging the Gaps between Computational Methods and Critical/Cultural Perspectives (\$1,200), University of Utah Sep 2023

JOURNAL REVIEWER

Journal of Advertising (Student & Junior Faculty Reviewer Training Program) Aug 2024 - Jul 2025

New Media & Society May 2026

Journal of Communication Technology Dec 2025

Convergence: The International Journal of Research into New Media Technologies Oct 2024

SERVICE

Emerging Community Leaders Program (Local community volunteering and engagement), United Way of Champaign County Mar 2026 - Present

Academic Misconduct & Capricious Grading Committee, College of Media, UIUC Aug 2023 - Jul 2024

ICR Cohort Representative, College of Media, UIUC Aug 2023 - Jul 2024

President, *Newsweekly* (student media), School of Journalism and Comm, RUC Sep 2013 - Jun 2014

Vice President, Student Union, School of Journalism and Comm, RUC Sep 2013 - Jun 2014

HONORS AND AWARDS

Student Merit, Kam Fan Awards, 2015 Hong Kong 4As Students Advertising Awards Oct 2015

Excellent Undergraduate Thesis, RUC Jun 2015

Guanghua Scholarship for Outstanding Academic Records, RUC Oct 2014

Second Prize, the 6th China National Advertising Design Competition for College Students Jul 2014

Scholarship for Outstanding Student Organization Leader, RUC Dec 2013

CERTIFICATES

Certified Ethical Advertising Scholar (CEAS), granted by the Institute for Advertising Ethics	Jun 2025
AI Integrity Shield, granted by the Institute for Advertising Ethics	Jun 2025

MEMBERSHIPS

American Academy of Advertising (AAA)
International Communication Association (ICA)
Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC)

SKILLS

Programming & data analysis: Python, R, SPSS
Media production: Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Premiere
Languages: English (professional proficiency), Chinese (native speaker), Japanese (elementary proficiency)